

Section 1 - Chapter 1: Introduction, Goals and Purpose

Welcome to C# The Whole Story. Way back in 2019 I did a three-course series on C# and put it up on Udemy. Thousands of students have taken those courses. Unfortunately, like everything else in Computer Science, if it is over a couple years old it is probably getting stale. Such is the reason for this course. By the way, for those of you interested there is a parallel textbook available on Amazon. It can be very valuable if English is not your first language. To find it just search Rick Phillips Ph.D. and it will come up along with all my other books. Sorry about the price but it is on-demand publishing which unfortunately is significantly more expensive.

Why are we here, what are we going to learn and why this course over the many others covering the C# programming language? First the why are we here. We are here to learn the C# programming language. This course assumes no prior programming experience so welcome to all you beginners. If you are already familiar with an object-oriented programming language like Java, please feel free to skip the first two sections and jump right into the examples in sections 3 and 4. That is where the heavy lifting occurs.

Next, what are we going to learn. We are going to learn how to make a very good living as a C# programmer using Microsoft's Visual Studio, Microsoft's SQL Server, Microsoft's Sequel Server Management Suite, Oracle's MySQL Workbench and Microsoft's XML Notepad. What is the good news? All these tools are free. Twenty bucks for this course and a bunch of work on your part and you are ready to rock and roll as a C# programmer. Not too bad.

Finally, why this course over the many others available here on Udemy. Five words: Real World Experience and Examples. No academic snippet code here and I am going to teach you all the shortcuts.

I lived this stuff for over 20 years. Worked with small teams, big teams, Oracle, Microsoft, C#, PL/SQL, Java, Javascript and a half dozen other tools. As they say, "been there and done it." Check out the reviews of my previous courses and of my books on Amazon. Students like the way I teach and appreciate the real-world experience and examples.

So, what are we going to cover?

- Section 1: Introduction
 - Ch 1: Introduction, Goals and Purpose
 - Ch 2: Setup our Sandbox
- Section 2: The Basics
 - Ch 3: Hello World
 - Ch 4: Variables, Data Types and Operators
 - Ch 5: Flow Control
 - Ch 6: Old School Data Structures
 - Ch 7-8: Classes
 - Ch 9: Namespaces and Error Handling
 - Ch 10: File I/O
- Section 3: GUI Stuff
 - Ch 11 A-B: Simple Calculator
 - Ch 12 A-B: Matching Game
 - Ch 13: Cascading Dropdown Boxes
 - Ch 14: Movement and Tweening
 - Ch 15 A-B: Storefront
 - Ch 16 A-B: Online Learning and Testing
 - Ch 17: AI Generated C#
- Section 4: More Data Please
 - Ch 18: Relational Database Fundamentals
 - Ch 19 A-B: SQL
 - Ch 20: Making a Connection
 - Ch 21: DB Reads and Updates
 - Ch 22: Stored Procedures
 - Ch 23: XML
- Section 5: Wrap up
 - Ch 24: Deployment

So how is this going to work you ask? Good question. I have been involved with adult education for the past 22 years. I started with Castle Worldwide where we put certification training and testing online throughout the world. After my retirement I started teaching here on Udemy, same basic principles. Divide every lesson up into three parts. Begin by telling the students what they should expect to learn and why it is important within the context of their everyday lives. Next, teach them the actual content for that lesson. Wrap up by reminding them what they were taught and how it fits into the larger picture of the course.

Now as to documentation for this course. Every chapter (except the first two where there is no source code file) will have at least two associated resource files. The first one will contain my script for the chapter. Any additional files will contain all the source code referenced within the chapter. Hey, guess what the companion textbook contains? Sure, all those same script files so if you want to save some money just print out all those resource files and put them in a 3-ring binder.

One more thing before I wrap up this quick introduction. I want to apologize now for my spelling, grammar and punctuation throughout this course and the companion textbook and resource files. I know perfectly well how to use a semicolon, it ends a C# or PL/SQL command. Unfortunately, I have no idea how to use one in a sentence. Sorry, please forgive me, I design software, not sentences.

Hope you stay for the duration and remember, go out there and have some fun today, but always learn something new every day, because that is what is really important.